Chapter 2: Marketing - Stakeholder Analysis, Market Segmentation, Customer Journey

I. Introduction

The Ballet Program at Hillview Estate (BPHE) aims to advance SDG 4: Quality Education, seeking inclusive and quality education and, SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities, which seeks social inclusion of all people regardless of status (United Nations, 2025). Meeting these goals depends on ensuring promotion and branding reaches the right audience. Without meaningful segmentation, classes would likely be filled by families who can afford private classes, or only girls, overlooking the groups both goals aim to support. This chapter establishes the foundation for branding and sponsorship strategies, exploring areas of stakeholder analysis, market segmentation to prioritise underserved groups; and customer journey mapping to evaluate families' experiences from first awareness to performance.

II. Stakeholder Analysis

As a community program operating on a leased heritage state, BPHE relies on many stakeholders with varying degrees of influence: the King's Foundation which governs access to the Hillview Estate, grant bodies and sponsors which help keep classes cost low, and parents who enrol and transport each child. Each stakeholder is viewed as a relationship that needs to be built not just an audience to keep informed. To analyse these relationships the department applied the six markets model which determines that an organisation can only build strong customer relationships if they also manage its relationships with other relevant stakeholders (Payne, Ballantyne and Christopher 2005). Following its four-step process, the department identified the stakeholders in each market, reviewed what each group expects, how much monitoring each group requires and set a relationship strategy (Table 1).

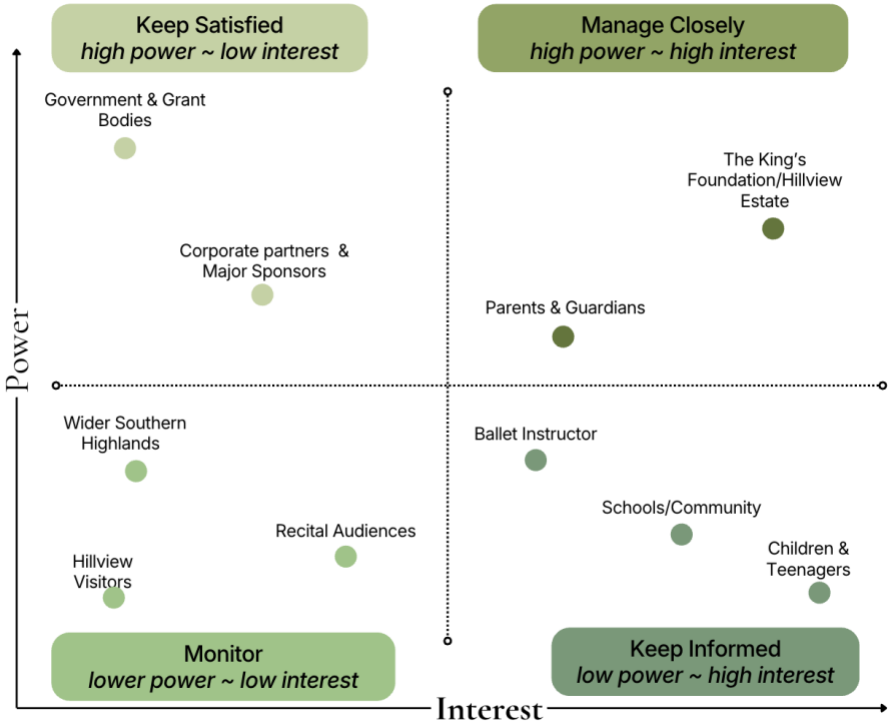
Table 1: BPHE's six stakeholder markets (adapted from Payne, Ballantyne and Christopher 2005)

Market	Stakeholders	What they expect	Value	Relationship Strategy
Customer	Parents (decision-makers); children and teenagers (end users)	Affordable, safe, confidence-building classes	Enrolments and class fees	Manage parents closely; support children through the first four weeks
Referral	Schools,	Regulated class	Trusted access to	Partner on

	community groups, satisfied parents	program, WWCC for instructors and reviewed	target families	outreach
Influence	Government, grant bodies, sponsors, media	Visible SDG 4 and SDG 10 impact	Funding and credibility	Keep satisfied through regular impact reporting
Supplier and alliance	King's Foundation/Hillview Estate, equipment suppliers	Community use of the estate	Venue and heritage setting	Manage closely
Recruitment	Qualified prospective instructors as classes expand	Paid teaching and a training pathway	Qualified, accredited staff	Fund accreditation
Internal	The ballet instructor	Clear processes and support	Quality teaching and safeguarding	Regular communication

It's important to engage all stakeholder groups, as the Senior Accountant, Lighthouse Service Partners observed, "you'll only ever get to the destination with everyone together". Schools and community organisations function as the program's referral market, directing families and providing trusted access to households the program most needs to reach. Parents start as customers, and then become a referral source once satisfied which makes the first four weeks of attendance critical for both retention and referral generation. The level of emphasis each stakeholder group should receive was determined by mapping all ten stakeholder groups on Mendelow's (1981) power–interest matrix (Figure 1) with each quadrant linked to an engagement strategy (Rahma et al. 2021). The King's Foundation and parents are managed closely, as the Foundation controls the venue and parents decide whether each child enrols and attends. Government, grant bodies and major sponsors are kept satisfied, since their funding warrants considerable power despite having limited interest in everyday operations. The ballet instructor, schools and children are kept informed, while the wider community, recital audiences and visitors are monitored. These were developed with the other departments: Schools and community groups become the main channels in Chapter 3's communication strategy, while the kept-satisfied sponsors are addressed through Chapter 5's sponsorship tiers.

Figure 1. Stakeholder Map



The matrix has a significant limitation, because an assessment based on power alone would rank children as the least important stakeholders despite being the group the program designs to benefit the most. The salience model which measures urgency alongside power ranked children and families as the highest (Mitchell, Lee & Agle 2017). It also identified parents as the decision-maker with the child as the end user, something to be considered by marketing activities.

III. Segmentation and Target Market

The marketing department applied the segmentation, targeting and positioning (STP) process across four segmentation bases (Sharp, Dawes and Victory, 2024). As the Analyst at The Law Society of NSW observed, insights drawn from data "would need to be simplified so that it plays into the wider strategy of the team" so segments are created to define groups for use by other departments.

Demographically, the program targets children and teenagers aged 5 - 17. Ballet is still widely perceived as an activity for girls, so the marketing department will explicitly target gender-inclusive participation which supports SDG 10's aim of eliminating gender disparities. Household targeting prioritises underserved and low-income families who perceive private studio costs as a barrier.

Geographically, the market is the Southern Highlands and surrounding communities, including Bowral, Moss Vale. As Hillview Estate sits at Sutton Forest, travel time is treated as a

segmentation variable as distance is an important factor that influences attendance just as much as income does.

In psychographic terms, the program appeals to families who value dance, physical activity, confidence-building and community connection. Behaviourally, it targets first-time participants, those seeking social activities, curiosity into dance and families seeking affordable extracurricular activity especially as the project includes extra classes during school holidays. All classes are offered at the beginner level with opportunities for expansion and growth of the program as discussed further in chapter 7.

Segmenting on existing interest in dance would skew towards families already drawn to ballet, which would exclude boys and children who lack confidence or may naturally show less initial interest. As a result, classes are uniformed and kept open to all families and a lack of interest is treated as a barrier to be addressed through communication rather than a reason for exclusion.

Table 2. Segment table (Combining the four bases produced five segments)

Segment	Profile	Role	Main Barrier
Aspiring Dancer (Alice)	Ages 5–9, new to ballet, keen to learn, perform and make friends	Core audience for weekly beginner classes	Limited local opportunities, private studio costs
Curious Beginner (Callum, 12)	Ages 10–17, first-time participants including boys, often low in confidence	Gender equity focus under SDG 4	Stereotypes and social attitudes/stigma towards boys in ballet
Anxious Parent (Hannah, 36)	Parent or guardian deciding on enrolment	Decision-maker and payer	Cost, transport to Sutton Forest, unclear pricing

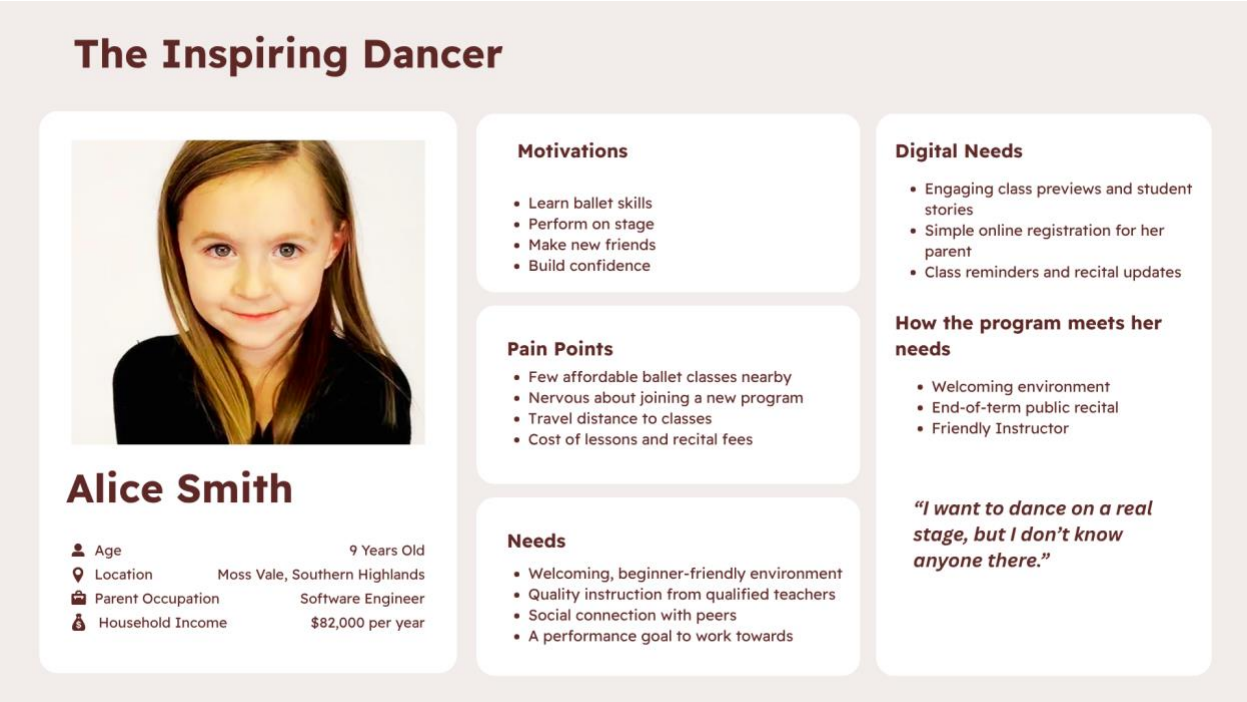
IV. Customer Profiles

To translate segmentation into actionable targets, the marketing department developed customer profiles, supported by three detailed personas created in Canva (Figure 2).

Developing several profiles rather than a single target customer reflects the advice of the Banking Operations Officer at HSBC to engage with people "from different education backgrounds", ensuring the program considers more than one perspective. The inspiring dancer represented by Alice, forms the program's core audience. She has always been interested in

learning ballet, wants to perform on stage and make friends, but is held back by limited local opportunities and the cost of private studios. The curious beginner represented through Callum, a twelve-year-old curious boy, reflects the gender equity focus. He is drawn to trying new things and secretly enjoys performing, but faces stereotypes and peer attitudes towards boys in ballet. The anxious parent represented through Hannah, a 36-year-old parent, represents the decision-maker. She seeks safe and meaningful activities but worries about overall costs, transport to Hillview and needs transparent pricing, convenient scheduling and simple registration. As these personas are built on assumptions rather than primary data, the department will validate them through a Qualtrics survey and discovery interviews.

Figure 2: The Customer Personas



The Curious Beginner



Callum Jones

Age	12 Years Old
Location	Bowral, Southern Highlands
Parent Occupation	Tradesperson (dual-income household)
Household Income	Middle Class

Motivations

- Trying new things
- Performing on stage
- Making new friends
- Enjoying movement and fitness

Pain Points

- Stereotypes that ballet is “for girls”
- Peer and family attitudes
- Nervous about an unfamiliar activity
- No previous dance experience

Needs

- Inclusive environment where boys feel welcome
- Equal representation in classes and imagery
- Beginner-friendly entry point
- Low-pressure way to try before committing

Digital Needs

- Beginner-friendly program information
- Class previews and videos, including boys dancing
- Easy way to contact teachers or other students

How the program meets her needs

- inclusive imagery and language across all marketing, and mixed-gender classes.

“I’d like to try it, but I’m worried what my mates will think.”

The Anxious Parent



Hannah Pham

Age	36 Years Old
Location	Mittagong, Southern Highlands
Parent Occupation	Nurse (Single Parent)
Household Income	Middle Class
Children	Two, aged 7, 11

Motivations

- Find safe, supervised activities
- Choose meaningful programs
- Support her children’s confidence and development

Pain Points

- Cost of extracurricular programs
- Transport to Hillview Estate
- Hidden costs for costumes and equipment
- Fitting activities around shift work

Needs

- Genuinely affordable participation
- Clear, upfront information about any additional costs
- Convenient scheduling
- Qualified instructors

Digital Needs

- Simple online registration
- Automated class reminders
- One communication channel for updates and changes

How the program meets her needs

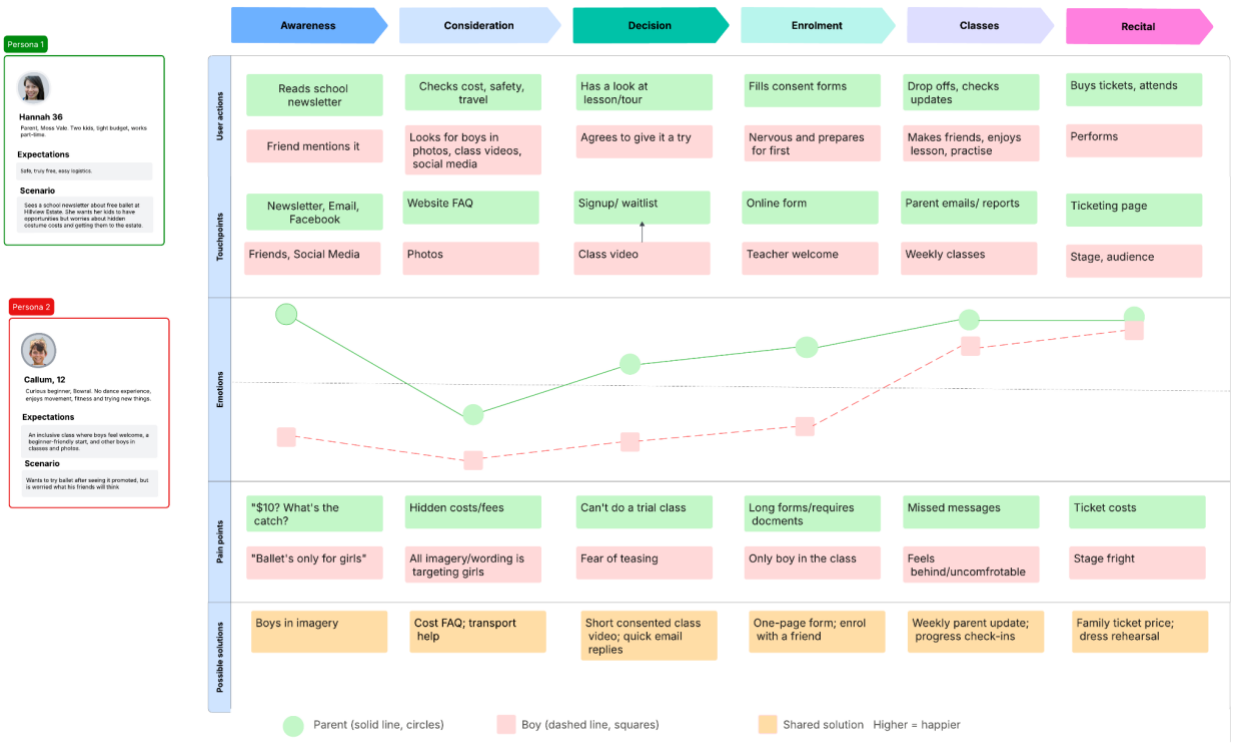
- Clear communication with transparent cost information, weekend scheduling, transport coordination, and Working With Children Check-cleared instructors.

“I want my kids to have opportunities, but I can’t afford surprise costs.”

V. Customer Journey

Building on the personas, the marketing department mapped Hannah and Callum's journey across 5 stages from pre-purchase to post-purchase stages, shaped by touchpoints (Lemon and Verhoef, 2016). Developed in Lucidchart, the map shows the parent's and child's perspectives in parallel. The parents' journey is practical, centred on cost, time and transport, while the child's is emotional, moving from curiosity and nervousness to belonging. Lemon and Verhoef (2016) identified that the model can overlook long-term loyalty and focuses on the outcome or enrolment. However, the customer journey map identifies that the critical moment is actually the first four weeks, when a nervous child is most likely to withdraw. Adapting the "manual of me" that The Former People Partner at Canva described for new starters, the marketing department proposes adding a short personalisation quiz covering each child's interests, confidence and any concerns so the instructor can understand each student before their first class to support retention. Each stage is measured using marketing technologies: Qualtrics for surveys, Meta Business Suite and Google Analytics for reach and conversion, and Mailchimp for automated reminders. To capture word-of-mouth referrals, the enrolment form will ask families how they heard about the program.

Figure 3. Customer Journey Map



VI. Conclusion & Reflection

The analysis concludes that BPHE's contribution to SDG 4 and SDG 10 depends more on removing non-price barriers such as transport and confidence than on demand for $10 classes. It is recommended that trusted outreach through schools are prioritised with success measured by the share of enrolments from priority families over total numbers alone. Following the Clinical Research Nurse at the Woolcock Institute's advice to know "what each person brings to the table", the stakeholder analysis revealed schools as an opportunity to reach these families.

The same principle applied within the team. Each department brought different priorities: as the marketing member responsible for market research, I focused on the audience perspective, while the finance members focused on what the program could feasibly fund. When I proposed fee waivers and trial classes, the finance member's modelling showed they were not financially feasible, so I refocused on reaching families through the standard $10 fee rather than discounts. In Tuckman's model of team development, this was our storming stage which took the form of disagreement rather than conflict. Resolving it moved us into norming, where we "agree on..… working styles and systems to follow" (Kumar, Deshmukh & Adhish 2014).

Overall, our team worked well together, communicating openly and supporting each other's chapters. The main challenge I faced was understanding the other departments' work, particularly how the finance model's assumptions about pricing, capacity and scheduling affected my segments and customer journey. As the Analyst at The Law Society of NSW discussed, team members sometimes "don't see eye to eye" because they come from different perspectives, yet "that difference is a good point of decision making where we can go back and revisit some of our points". Upon reflection, holding more discussions early on to go through the program's logistics across departments would have helped me understand decisions sooner and reduced the need to adapt my chapter later.

VII. References

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